

The Morning Newspaper

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 9, 2026 · AUSTIN EDITION

90° / 67°

Overcast, 0% rain, wind up to 6 mph

Tomorrow: 90° / 66°, clear

Sunrise 7:29 · Sunset 19:06

● Waning crescent

Pentagon says it will livestream a soldier's execution

The firing-squad death of Fort Hood shooter Nidal Hasan, set for Dec. 3, would be the first public execution in modern U.S. history.

WORLD

Pentagon to livestream Fort Hood shooter's execution

BBC · THE GUARDIAN · NYT

Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth said the firing-squad execution of Maj. Nidal Hasan, convicted over the 2009 Fort Hood shooting, will be carried out in public and streamed live on Dec. 3. The United Nations said broadcasting it could amount to torture, and psychiatrists warned that watching an execution live risks causing post-traumatic stress in viewers.

Ethiopia warns Eritrea after troops cross border

BBC NEWS

Ethiopia said it will defend itself after Eritrean troops crossed into its territory, with truckloads of soldiers reportedly moving over the border. Addis Ababa has already responded with drone strikes, raising fears of a wider conflict between the two Horn of Africa neighbors.

TECH

Meta pushed out Muse despite internal safety concerns

THE NEW YORK TIMES · TECHMEME

The Times reports Mark Zuckerberg pressed ahead with Meta's Muse AI agent even after internal testers flagged security and privacy problems, including a case where the assistant surfaced private photos unprompted. Meta says safeguards keep Muse from directly handling passwords or payments, and that it delayed the launch earlier this year to tighten security.

Jev maker TypeSafe AI raises \$870M at \$7.5B valuation

TECHMEME · BLOOMBERG

TypeSafe AI, maker of the agent Jev that went viral after launch, raised roughly \$870 million in a round led by Andreessen Horowitz, with Sequoia and other investors joining. The round values the young company at \$7.5 billion, underscoring how much money is still chasing buzzy AI agent startups.

MARKETS

INDEX	LAST	CHG
S&P 500	7,784.12	+0.24%
Dow Jones	51,364.35	+0.26%
Nasdaq	27,272.97	+0.29%
Russell 2000	2,800.99	+0.25%
VIX	15.11	-1.95%
10-yr yield	5.26	+0.50%

CRYPTO

Bitcoin	\$82,458	+0.73%
Ethereum	\$2,482.32	-1.15%

STOCKS

NVDA	\$231.44	+0.42%
AAPL	\$332.47	-2.33%
MSFT	\$527.93	+1.02%
GOOGL	\$352.08	+1.09%
AMZN	\$257.71	+1.44%
META	\$718.13	-0.38%
AVGO	\$364.79	+1.29%
TSLA	\$387.32	+3.29%
SPCX	\$163.61	+1.89%
BRK-B	\$514.75	+0.72%
TSM	\$456.97	-0.23%

Major indices drifted to fresh highs, with the S&P 500, Dow, Nasdaq and Russell 2000 all closing roughly a quarter of a percent higher. The VIX fell further, signaling easing anxiety, even as the 10-year Treasury yield ticked up to 5.26%, a reminder that rate pressure hasn't fully lifted. Tesla led the stock moves with a 3.29% jump, while Apple lagged, down 2.33%; bitcoin edged higher as ether slipped. Broadcom and Nvidia both added to their recent runs, keeping chipmakers at the front of the rally even as some strategists warn AI-linked valuations are getting stretched.

WORD OF THE DAY

Ultracrepidarian (adj.) — someone who gives opinions on subjects outside their expertise. English essayist William Hazlitt coined it in 1819, borrowing a Latin phrase meaning "beyond the sole of the shoe." Social media has made the vice easier than ever to practice at scale.

FROM THE FEEDS · FULL TEXT IN SECTION B

AEON

Barbara Ward's vision — an early argument that prosperity, equality and protecting nature are inseparable goals.

ASTRAL CODEX TEN

Ballots Everywhere: Times & Places — a practical rundown of where and when to vote.

LONGREADS

Top 5 Longreads of the Week — picks on data centers, AI's labor takeover and more.

LONGREADS

Inside the subreddit where men share their dinners — and their feelings — a 4-million-member community built on vulnerability.

NAUTILUS

A recipe for stopping AI from going rogue — a proposed formula to keep models from acting dangerously.

NAUTILUS

Single orangutan moms set up playdates for their kids — evidence of deliberate social planning in the wild.

NAUTILUS

An elephant's 700,000-year-old tooth reveals a lost habitat of our ancient ancestors.

TRICYCLE

Our Appointment with Life — a late Zen master on returning to the present moment.

AEON

Barbara Ward's vision

OR ROSENBOIM · AEON.CO · OCT 9, 2026

A historical essay on the first thinker to argue prosperity, equality and ecology are inseparable goals.

In 1957, the economist and journalist Barbara Ward gave the first of the Aggrey-Fraser-Guggisberg Memorial Lectures at the University College of Ghana. Shortly after Kwame Nkrumah led the British colony of the Gold Coast towards self-government, he invited Ward to address the independent country's first cohort of students. Ward was well acquainted with the local political landscape because she had spent the previous four years living in the Gold Coast, witnessing its political transformation. As the world's eyes were set on Ghana, the first sub-Saharan colony to achieve independence from European rule, Ward was determined to provide her audience with the knowledge needed to govern their newly founded country.

Her lectures, titled *Five Ideas that Change the World*, developed a world-historical narrative of the supposed human progress from nationalism to colonialism, industrialism, communism, and finally to internationalism, the highest point of political order.



Continued online (full article about 3452 words). Scan, or visit <https://aeon.co/essays/why-we-should-heed-barbara-wards-vision-of-planetary-justice>

Ghana's peaceful democratic transition showed that African colonies were ready to govern themselves, weakening European arguments about the need for prolonged imperial guidance. The country soon became a model for new African statehood based on postcolonial sovereignty, inspiring other colonies on the continent to join the decolonisation process, which culminated in the 'Year of Africa' in 1960. The charismatic Nkrumah, who ruled Ghana from 1957 to 1966, became an international player in Cold War diplomacy by promoting pan-Africanist visions of post-imperial unity. He wanted to show the world that Africans were no longer imperial subjects but important and influential members of the global political community. While Nkrumah was a vociferous opponent of colonialism, Ward uncritically appreciated the civilisational and technical legacies of empire. Yet in her lectures, she supported Nkrumah's international political aspirations by suggesting that economic development, international cooperation, and even world peace were interrelated problems that warranted a planetary solution.

LONGREADS

Inside the Subreddit Where Men Share Their Dinners—And Their Most Intimate Feelings

CAROLYN WELLS · LONGREADS.COM · OCT 8, 2026

Reporting on a 4-million-member community built around men opening up to strangers.

r/BoyDinnerDiaries is a subreddit where men post photos of their often rather sad-looking meals alongside their most private worries. Zack Hauptman carefully explores this unusual place for community and care, meeting the men who are learning to share more than just what is on their plate. We hear a lot about the "male loneliness epidemic," so it's heartening to glimpse even a small shift in the other direction.

Others use the forum regardless of whether they have a vast social circle. Robert*, 31, says he has many people to turn to but uses Reddit when he needs to unload his feelings further. "I have an urge to vent when I don't want to call a friend," he says. In August, after experiencing repeated rejection from women he was seeing, he decided to post about it online. "I'm at the point where I feel so

disappointed and let down but also so grateful that I have the opportunity to learn and grow from all of it," he wrote alongside a photo of mushy canned tuna in a bowl. "I could talk about it pretty much all the time, but I don't really want to be doing that," he says. "Going to the subreddit...it's like throwing it into the void."

"At the Men of War Crucible, you bear-crawl through rivers. At Warrior Week, you dig your own grave. At the Squire Program, your teen-ager can take part, too."

"For all these reasons—the socialization we receive as kids, as well as emotional restraint, homophobia, experiences of betrayal, and many others—many men stop confiding in each other, trusting each other, supporting each other, and expressing emotion around each other."

TRICYCLE: THE BUDDHIST REVIEW

Our Appointment with Life

THICH NHAT HANH · TRICYCLE.ORG · OCT 9, 2026

A late Zen master's essay on coming home to the present moment.

To return to the present is to be in contact with life. Life can be found only in the present moment, because the past no longer is and the future has not yet come. Buddhahood, liberation, awakening, peace, joy, and happiness can only be found in the present moment. Our appointment with life is in the present moment. The place of our appointment is right here, in this very place.

According to the Avatamsaka Sutra, time and space are not separate. Time is made up of space, and space is made up of time. When we speak about spring, we usually think of time, but spring is also space. When it is spring in Europe, it is winter in Australia.

When we have a tea mediation, those who attend breathe in and out and recite the following gatha together before taking the first sip of tea:

This cup of tea in my two hands—
mindfulness is held uprightly.



Continued online (full article about 1412 words). Scan, or visit <https://tricycle.org/article/thich-nhat-hanh-mindfulness/>

My mind and body dwell

in the very here and now.

When we drink tea in mindfulness, we practice coming back to the present moment to live our life right here. When our mind and our body are fully in the present moment, then the steaming cup of tea appears clearly to us. We know it is a wonderful aspect of existence. At that time we are really in contact with the cup of tea. It is only at times like this that life is really present.

Peace, joy, liberation, awakening, happiness, Buddhahood, the source—everything we long for and seek after can only be found in the present moment. To abandon the present moment in order to look for these things in the future is to throw away the substance and hold on to the shadow.

NAUTILUS

A Recipe for Stopping AI from Going Rogue

KRISTEN FRENCH · NAUTIL.US · OCT 8, 2026

A proposed formula for keeping language models from taking dangerous actions.

What makes an AI chatbot go “rogue”? It has become a pressing question in recent weeks. One pair of researchers from George Washington University think they have an answer, and possibly even a way to prevent it from happening in the future. Professor of physics Neil Johnson, who studies complex systems, and physics PhD student Frank Yingjie Huo published a paper about their formula today in the peer-reviewed journal *Patterns*. Johnson and Huo argue that there is a visible “tipping point” embedded in the internal code of an AI chatbot when it goes off the rails—encouraging users to self-harm, spreading medical misinformation, or supporting violent points of view, for example. Where this tipping point lies depends on where certain concepts are stored on the giant semantic map within the AI agent’s network, and it can be nudged. Nobody draws this map for the AI. It develops

during training and tends to situate ideas that are similar, such as garbage and stink, close together, while ideas that are unrelated sit far apart.

Every time an AI chatbot gives an answer, it picks one word at a time, relying on everything that has been written so far, including your questions and its own answers. But while the AI might start out saying unequivocally helpful things, it can suddenly switch to saying something harmful. That’s because it is constantly checking how relevant each earlier word is to the one it’s deliberating on now, giving more weight to the most relevant ones. If that blend becomes skewed in some way—say if the good words sit close to a bad answer on the internal map—each good word can pull the chatbot in the wrong direction until it reaches the tipping point, according to Johnson and Huo.



Continued online (full article about 3072 words). Scan, or visit <https://nautil.us/a-recipe-for-stopping-ai-from-going-rogue-1285647/>